

Highlights of union budget 2015-16

The NDA government has announced its first full-fledged union budget. Finance minister Arun Jaitley, recognising the damage that inverted duties have caused to manufacturing in the country, has reduced customs duty on a number of inputs. He has abolished basic customs duty on imported raw material.

Jaitley has also looked at the excise duty structure applicable to certain items and carried out rationalisation to provide boost to devices like LED drivers, mobile handsets, tablets, computers, IC wafers and some specified raw materials, among others.



Finance minister outside Parliament House with budget papers in briefcase

This is believed to be a good beginning to realise the full potential of electronics hardware in restricting huge foreign exchange outflows and creation of substantial number of jobs. However, Jaitley has not been able to meet the expectations with respect to relief to tax payers, both corporate and individuals. The budget includes a proposal to reduce the corporate tax from 30 per cent to 25 per cent over the next four years beginning from the next financial year, but this will be accompanied by withdrawal of exemptions.

Jaitley has declared that the government is committed to a stable taxation policy and a non-adversarial

Vodafone India CTSO Burgess Coope quits

Telecom major Vodafone India's chief technology security officer, Burgess Cooper, has left the organisation after a nine-year stint to join global consultancy firm Ernst & Young. He was responsible for ensuring Vodafone's information security and privacy system. He also ensured compliance to ISO certifications in the organisation.

Infosys splits HR head role

India's second largest software services firm, Infosys, has undertaken an organisation reshuffle that will

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result in current global HR head, Srikantan Moorthy, moving to a new delivery function role. Binod Hampapur Rangadore, Executive vice president, will lead overall talent fulfillment function, which includes mass recruitment, training and personnel allocation.

Rishad Premji to head Wipro's CTO office

Rishad Premji, eldest son of Wipro chairman Azim Premji, who currently runs strategy, will now have the CTO office reporting to him. The office has around 200 people working on newer technology areas like cognitive computing.

system design and manufacturing (ESDM) industry, has announced the submission of detailed project report (DPR) for the proposed electronics manufacturing cluster (EMC) in Pune, Maharashtra, in association with Maharashtra Chamber of Commerce Industries and Agriculture (MCCIA).

As knowledge partners to MIDC and MCCIA, IESA has extended support to prepare and submit the preliminary application with the project report for a proposed common facilities centre (CFC) in Pune, under the guidelines of the EMC scheme of Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY), government of India.

Government allocates funds to MSME sector

The government of India has allocated more than ₹ 33 billion, the highest allocation in the last three financial years, to develop the micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) sector and is implementing a special programme to develop infrastructure to improve productivity and competitiveness of MSMEs in the country.

MSMEs account for more than 37 per cent of the GDP and more than

tax administration, which will, hopefully, encourage fresh investments. The 'Make in India' campaign will lead not only to the revival of growth and investment but also to the promotion of domestic manufacturing and enormous job creation. As a step to encourage the campaign, Jaitley has reduced the rate of income tax on royalty and fee for technical services from 25 per cent to 10 per cent, which should facilitate technology inflow.

IESA collaborates with MIDC and MCCIA

India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA), the premier trade body representing the Indian electronic